Place a flash bulb at the middle of your car. Trigger the bulb. It sends a burst of light forward toward the front of your car, and a burst backward toward the back of your car. Since the two bursts are emitted simultaneously, and since they travel the same distance as measured by you in your car, and since they travel at the same speed (the speed of light is absolute), they must arrive at the front and back of your car simultaneously from your viewpoint; see the left diagram, below. The two events of burst arrival (call them *A* at your car's front and *B* at its back) are thus simultaneous from your viewpoint, and they happen to coincide with the firecracker detonations of Figure 1.3, as seen by you.

Next, examine the light bursts and their arrival events *A* and *B* from my viewpoint as your car speeds past me; see the right diagram, below. From my viewpoint, the back of your car is moving forward, toward the backward-directed burst of light, and they thus meet each other (event *B)* sooner as seen by me than as seen by you. Similarly, the front of your car is moving forward, away from the frontward-directed burst, and they thus meet each other (event *A)* later as seen by me than as seen by you. (These conclusions rely crucially on the fact that the speeds of the two light bursts are the same as seen by me; that is, they rely on the absoluteness of the speed of light.) Therefore, I regard event *B* as occurring before event *A;* and similarly, I see the firecrackers near the back of your car detonate before those near the front.

